Debugging Workflow

Step 1: Open and Duplicate the Workflow

To keep our first workflow clean, we will duplicate it for this exercise.

1. Open your browser and navigate to your n8n workspace.
2. In the **Workflows** dashboard, open `My First N8N Workflow`.
3. Click on the three dots menu button in the top-right corner of the editor.
4. Select **Duplicate**.
5. Rename the duplicated workflow to `Topic 2 Debugging Workflow` and click **Save**.

Step 2: Add an Error-Prone Node

We will add an HTTP Request node configured to hit a fake URL to simulate a connection error.

1. Hover over the right edge of the **Edit Fields (Set)** node and click the gray + icon.
2. In the search panel, type `HTTP Request`.
3. Select the **HTTP Request** node from the list.
4. Double-click the newly added **HTTP Request** node to open its configuration panel on the right.
5. Configure the node as follows:
    a. **Method:** `GET` (default).
    b. **URL:** Type https://this-domain-does-not-exist-12345.com.
6. Close the configuration panel.

Step 3: Run the Workflow and Identify the Error

1. Click the orange **Test workflow** button at the bottom-center of the canvas.
2. Watch the workflow execute.
    a. The **Manual Trigger** and **Edit Fields (Set)** nodes will show **green checkmarks**.
    b. The execution stops at the **HTTP Request** node.
    c. The **HTTP Request** node will be outlined in **red** and display a red **warning/error badge**.

Step 4: Inspect Input and Output Panels

1. Double-click the failed **HTTP Request** node to open its details panel.
2. Look at the data panels on the right side of the screen:

a. **Input Tab:** Click the **Input** tab at the top. Here, you will see the incoming JSON data from the previous node:
```
[
  {
    "greeting": "Hello, n8n!"
  }
]
```
(This confirms that data entered the node correctly).

b. **Output / Error Tab:** Click the **Output** tab. You will see a detailed error message:
```
{
  "message": "getaddrinfo ENOTFOUND
this-domain-does-not-exist-12345.com",
  "name": "NodeApiError",
  "code": "ENOTFOUND",
  ...
}
```
(This explains exactly why the node failed—it could not resolve the web address).

Step 5: Test step (Step-by-Step Execution)

Instead of running the entire workflow from the beginning, you can run single nodes to test changes.

1. Change the URL in the HTTP Request configuration to a valid https://1cb106c19a1049339451476e8e4885c5.api.mockbin.io/
2. Do **not** click "Test workflow" at the bottom.
3. Instead, click the **Test step** button inside the **HTTP Request** node configuration panel (or hover over the node on the canvas and click the tiny play icon).
4. The node will execute by itself, using the mock input data.
5. The node's red border will change to **green**, indicating success.

Step 6: Review Historical Execution Logs

1. Click the **X** to close the configuration panel and go back to the canvas.
2. In the far-left sidebar navigation panel, click on **Executions** (indicated by an execution list icon).
3. Here you will see a list of all your previous test runs:
    a. Completed runs are shown with a **green checkmark**.
    b. Failed runs are shown with a **red cross mark**.
4. Click on the first failed run in the list.
5. The historical execution viewer loads. You can click on each node to see exactly what data entered and exited it during that specific run.
6. To return to the editable canvas, click **Back to editor** in the top-left corner.